THE SETONIAN

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NOW Is the Time for All Good . . .

[Editor's note: We have temporarily dispensed with our regular policy of printing letters to the paper on the second page, because, like the women who felt strongly enough to call this situation to light, we feel it deserves (in fact demands) your most immediate attention and careful reflection, and of course, we welcome comments and replies, both pro and con.]

Editor:

This week is International Women.s Year week at the Mall. Seton Hill College is supervising the event and has dropped NOW (the National Organization for Women from its list of participants. It is my belief that this decision is an unjust one based on esoteric religious dogma. Seton Hill as an educational institution should be objective in their selection. Therefore, I feel a full explanation is due.

Concerned Individual

Dear Editor,

The celebration of International Women's Year is a favorable sign of Seton Hill's recognition of the importance of women in today's world. However, this celebration is just a face, a public relations stunt without an understanding of what International Women's Year is all about. Seton Hill administration invited NOW, the National Organization of Women, to set up a display during the activities at Greengate Mall. Just three weeks before the celebration, Seton Hill refused to let NOW participate, solely on a judgment of NOW's stand on the abortion issue. This seems unfair, considering no one condemns such organizations as the Y.W.C.A. on their pro-abortion stand. Seton Hill, by condemning NOW, is ignoring NOW's many contributions in Greensburg and across the country in promoting equal rights for both women and men. NOW'S goals are very much a part of the International Women's Year, and we cannot ignore NOW the way the administration proposes to do. If we cannot accept all our sisters in womanhood, then we are far from being a place where women lead.

Sincerely,
Mary Jo Ruefle
box 317

Editor:

I regret that I cannot support the Seton Hill College observance of International Women's Year at Greengate Mall this week. The following circumstances dhould give us all pause:

1) The National Organization of Women, which has succeeded more than any other women's group in effecting positive changes in the status of women, was first **invited** to participate in the observance; but then the invitation was **withdrawn**, because of a misinformed notion on its stand on abortion. NOW is **not** pro-abortion; what it demands is every woman's right to choose. The YWCA **is** pro-abortion, and **has been invited**to participate in the SHC observance!

2) The SHC Director of College Relations (male), when faced with opposition from within the Seton Hill community to this discourteous and unprincipled treatment of NOW, saw fit to consult **outside** the College community with the Assistant Bishop of the Greensburg Diocese (also male). The Bishop, equally misinformed, directed that the invitation be withdrawn. But the Bishop's directive is **entirely gratuitous**, should not have been sought, and has no bearing whatever on invitations to speak, write, or participate in discussions or other activities sponsored by Seton Hill College as an academic institution. Any such interference or request for interference must be regarded as an infringement of academic freedom and resisted by every member of the Seton Hill community, students, faculty and administration, and by everyone who values a free and open exchange of ideas in the Greensburg Community. The Seton Hill administrator in ques- persists in regarding his "mistake" as an error in tactics rather than an error in Principle. I regard it as a very serious error in principle.

3) To my knowledge, no faculty member – certainly none of the faculty members who have been active in promoting Women courses as respectable academic subjects – was consulted in the decision about NOW's participation.

4) As a footnote to all this, it has come to light that the President of Seton Hill routinely clears the commencement speaker with the Bishop of the Greensburg Diocese. No such consultation is offered or expected from St. Vincent College. I cannot help interpreting this hierarchical involvement in a matter of internal policy as an example of the second -class status of Seton Hill as a women's college, which the administration insists on perpetuating.

Finally, we should support International Women's Year, women who observe and promote IWY, and Seton Hill as a women's college "where women lead." But above all we should support the efforts of women to liberate themselves from institutional sexism, witting or unwitting; in particular we should support the National Organization of Women.

Sincerely,
Lynn Conroy, S.C.
Assoc. Prof. of English

Fast Thursday

Last year, Seton Hill College was involved in a fast for world hunger in which Both SVC and the public participated. The goal of the fast was to raise money for the starving humans overseas. We were very pleased with the response of the colleges, not only because we were able to raise a donation, but also because we saw people who could be actively concerned about a disastrous situation that did not involve them directly. Our total effort which raised $645.90, can be broken down as follows:

$476.62 – Seton Hill College
$113.60 – Saint Vincent Archabbey
$ 44.46 – Saint Vincent College
$ 11.22 – personal donation (anonymous)

This year (as a result of last year's interest), we have created the World Hunger Organization (WHO), which will attempt to deal with immediate situations where help is needed. We want to have a direct line of communication with those we wish to aid, so as to assure that our donation will not be used in an inoperative way. In other words, our donation will go directly to the need.

On October 29, we will hold our first fast for "Inner City," an organization co-directed by Patti and Rod Radle, with whom I have discussed their situation. They are operating a 24-hour "open house" which gives immediate aid to anyone seeking food, shelter or clothing. They also run a recreational program for the children of the area. Their sole income is the money they receive while on tour.

I would like to share with you some of the insights I received about their program while talking to them during SHGA weekend. Patti, Rod and Rosanne (a staff member) are acutely aware of what they have and what they do not need. At every meal, they were conscious of avoiding waste, as they would try not to take more than they could eat; if they did, they would share it among themselves. They were aware of the value of having food in a quantity that could not be wasted, as they often have to go street-begging in order to help support their program.

WHO is asking that you become aware that "Inner City" is a selfless program aiming to aid those who may not have a meal to eat or a place to sleep. They are asking for your support. If you wish to take part in our fast, please contact either Joyce DiMaccio (box 421) or MaureenMalarkey (box 417). All we need is your name and I.D. number; we also invite you to take part in our bread service (5:00 p.m., Oct. 29 in the small dining room) in which we may, in some way, experience the value of food, what it means to others to have it, to need it or to be able to provide it to others.

Love,
maureen

editorial

I think that Sister Lynn's most informed and informative statement of her view of this whole situation can be interpreted as nothing less than the eloquent, ardent yet rational, and very righteous judgment that it is. Any attempt that one might subsequently make to demean or ridicule the stand of all three of these women would collapse beneath the weight of her argument alone.

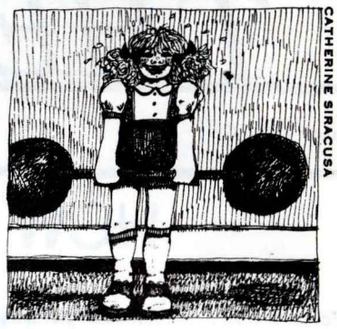
This is only a beginning — we should not let ourselves rest on Sister Lynn's laurels: we must constantly question the institutions around us, the men who, on the whole, have formulated and entrenched them within our culture, the women who, wittingly or not, reinforce them, and ultimately, our very selves, whether or not we are doing all we can to? liberate oppressed peoples. As women, we are part of the largest oppressed minority (this is something of a contradiction in terms, since women do represent 53.3% of the population).

I find that as women's colleges go, Seton Hill has not entirely misjudged its course of action: it has been oftentimes fair and innovative in the ways it has sought to equalize the status of women and men. It has not discriminated against men within the college: we see many talented men on the teaching faculty, and the administration is not without its male luminaries. When male students majoring at Seton Hill have distinguished themselves academically, the College has seen fit to honor them as it does one of its own students (we might note here that while Saint Vincent College does recognize academic excellence in its women students, i.e., those Setonians who must take their major courses there, the number of women on the administrative and teaching faculty is notable only in its ridiculously small size. Just because Saint Vincent has Traditionally been a bastion of male intellectual and religious activity is no reason for it to continue to so severely limit its horizons).

It is this heretofore promising movement of the college that makes this current situation both unfortunate and ridiculous. That a reactionary faction within the college could exert such pressure on the over-all image-forming of the institution presents itself to me as a perverse situation, to begin with. That an administrative head, whether male or female, would consult someone outside the college community, as to college policy, in light of the many informed and articulate Seton Hill persons available for consultation seems an indication of a foolish lack of thought. That all parties allowed themselves to remain so miserably misinformed is unforgivable, particularly in members of an institution of higher learning.

I sincerely wish that we at Seton Hill would find again the sense of courageous purpose that imbues our original motto, "Hazard Yet Forward." I fear that, to merely be a place where women lead, we need only consider the limitations of the ill-balanced society that lies not far behind, rather than the exciting possibilities which lie far ahead. In being simply the leaders of a lagging pack, we may find ourselves rushing yet backward, instead.

— Fran Murphy



CATHERINE SIRACUSA

TENURE

Cincinnati, Ohio —(I.P.) — In a report recommending the promotions of more than 100 faculty members and the granting of tenure to 15, the Academic Affairs Committee at the University of Cincinnati discussed the tenure situation at the University. The report, based on data provided by Vice President and Provost for Academic Affairs Gene Lewis, showed the following percentages for tenured faculty:

1972-73 48.0
1973-74 53.1
1974-75 62.0
1975-76 65.5

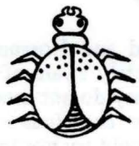
Lewis said the reason for increase in tenured faculty is that the size of of the faculty has not been growing so that younger members are not being added, and there is a decrease in faculty job mobility caused by decreasing employment opportunities.

The Committee report said that it "Recognised that tenure is not the challenge or the problem, but that maintaining a vigorous and productive faculty are issues which will confront us all in the years ahead. Faculty development is expensive but ways must be found to provide resources to support it."

en Espanol

by Ruthie Matinko

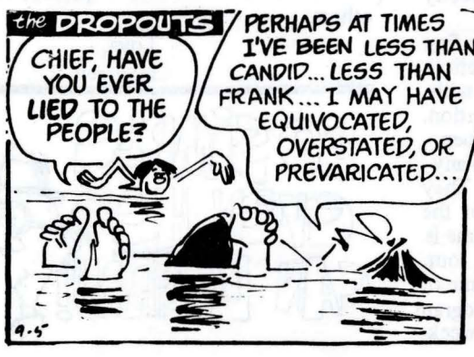
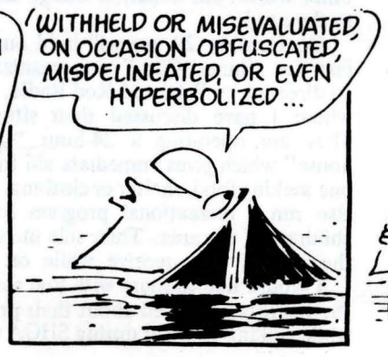
The Spanish Club of Seton Hill College is still making its mark. Continuing to be one of the college's most active clubs, it is contributing to the cultural enrichment of the community in various ways. One such outlet has been a donation to Reeves Memorial Library. The gift amounted to approximately $400 and is being used to purchase Spanish books. $330 of this contribution came jointly from the Seton Hill Spanish Club and the Spanish Cultural Club of Pittsburgh, as part of the entrance receipts of the very successful Festival Folklorico Hispanoamericano held in the Spring of 1975. The remainder of the gift has been contributed by the College Spanish Club, under the direction of Mrs. Angeles Stiteler. The donation, on the whole was made in the hope that more of the Seton Hill community would take interest and share in the language, culture and traditions of the Spanish-speaking peoples.



The Senior Rush

If you would like to volunteer some time to work on either of the class project committees, contact Liz Kramer (box 202-B) for the Memory Book Committee or Maggie Minor (box 243) for the Banner Committee.

Have an idea for a graduation speaker? Contact either:
Vicky Kramer - box 257
Linda Gratkowski - box 247
Marian Gasbarro - box 154-B
Cindy Little - box 257

Eco - Ed

Recognizing that the strength of the environmental movement comes comes from the grass roots and volunteer efforts, the College of Environmental Science and Forestry of the State University of New York has established the Sol Feinstone Awards of $1,000 each to go to five individuals "who by their voluntary action ... have made an outstanding contribution to ... improving the physical environment." For more information, write to the Feinstone Environmental Awards Committee, State University of New York College of Environmental Science and Forestry, Syracuse, N.Y. 13210.